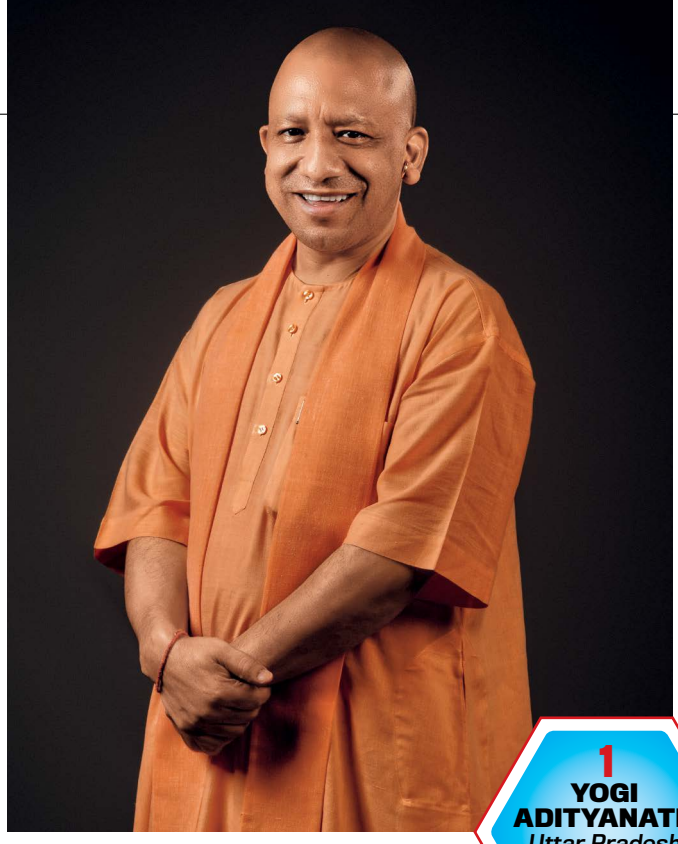


CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

1 YOGI ADITYANATH
Uttar Pradesh
46.3 [43]

MOOD OF THE NATION | BEST CMs

REIGNING SUPREME

No surprises here. UP chief minister Yogi Adityanath remains the most popular across India; Odisha CM Naveen Patnaik grabs the honour within home state

By KAUSHIK DEKA

In February this year, Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath achieved a new milestone, although in the virtual world. With 27.4 million followers on X (formerly Twitter), he emerged as the third most followed Indian politician after Prime Minister Narendra Modi (95.2 million) and Union home minister Amit Shah (34.4 million). However, his popularity is not restricted to social media. For eight times in a row in the INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll, respondents across the country have rated Adityanath as the best among the 30 chief ministers. And there is a consistent spike in his popularity—46.3 per cent of the respondents now view him as the best CM compared to 43 per cent who held the same opinion in August 2023. What makes his position even stronger is the gap between him and his immediate challenger Arvind Kejriwal. The Delhi chief minister is backed by only 19.6 per cent of the respondents.

Adityanath's pan-India popularity has often been attributed to his new model of governance—a blend of Hindutva politics with a tough stand on law and order. This MOTN poll has also seen the saffron-clad CM consolidate his position within the home state, with 51.3 per cent of the respondents in UP expressing satisfaction with his work, up from 46.9 per cent in the previous survey. This has placed him in sec-

Q MOST POPULAR CM ACROSS INDIA

Respondents across 30 states were asked to rate who they thought to be the best performing CM in the country



2. ARVIND KEJRIWAL *Delhi*
19.6 [19.1]



3. MAMATA BANERJEE *West Bengal*
8.4 [8.8]



4. M.K. STALIN *Tamil Nadu*
5.5 [5.6]



5. NAVEEN PATNAIK *Odisha*
2.5 [3]